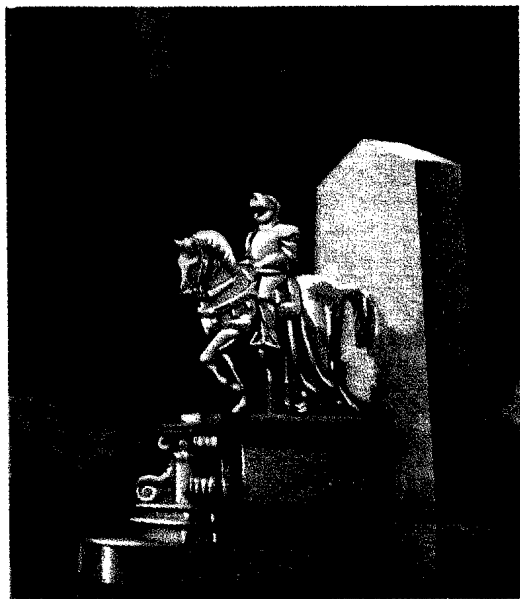


GRAND OPERA is a play set to music in which the characters act and sing their thoughts instead of speaking them. "Don Giovanni" (*Don Juan*) was written by the great Austrian composer, Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart. The story by Lorenzo da Ponte is based on a version called *The Stone Guest*. This great opera was produced for the first time in Prague in 1787. There are two acts and the plot is laid in Seville during the Seventeenth Century.



Don Juan, a gay Spanish nobleman, and his mischievous servant, Leporello, are always making people unhappy. Don tries to press his attentions on Anna, the beautiful daughter of the Commandant, who unexpectedly arrives. They fight a duel; the Commandant is killed while Don Juan and his servant escape. The townspeople erect a statue in honour of their dead commandant. While fleeing along a deserted road, Don Juan meets an old sweetheart, Elvira, who reproaches him but he escapes, leaving her alone with Leporello. We now find the gay cavalier in his palace flattering a beautiful peasant girl, Zerlina. He orders a gala festival and we hear the strains of the "MINUET", that graceful and courtly dance of the incomparable Mozart. Don Juan attempts to run away with Zerlina but is prevented by the appearance of Anna in search of the murderer of her father and Elvira who seeks revenge; Don Juan again takes to his heels. That night, near the statue of the slain commandant, Don and his servant plan other schemes. Suddenly, the statue speaks, warning them to mend their ways. Flippantly, Don invites the statue to dine with them. During the banquet, a heavy tramping is heard on the stairs. The statue enters the room, Don Juan seizes the marble hand when instantly the floor opens and demons drag the wicked Don Juan down amid flames and lightning.

Minuet from "Don Juan"

Mozart (1756-1791)

Moderato

p

mf

